

First Semester Check-In

FILL IN TOGETHER

Five minutes of structured questions that catch the problems students hide — money running out, a class going badly, not eating, not sleeping, no friends yet — while there is still time to fix them.

When: Week 4, week 8 and week 12 of the first term

The check-in

Ask these gently, three times a term. Not all at once.

How is the sleep?

TERRIBLE (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) FINE

Are you eating properly?

NO (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) YES

Do you have people there?

NOBODY YET (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) GOOD FRIENDS

How are the classes going, really?

BADLY (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) WELL

Is the money holding out?

NO (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) YES

Questions that get a real answer

- ☐ What is the hardest class, and have you been to office hours?
- ☐ Who did you eat with this week?
- ☐ Is there anything you have not told me because you thought I would worry?
- ☐ What do you need that you have not asked for?
- ☐ Have you been to the health centre or counselling for anything?

Things to act on

Deadlines that matter this term

- ☐ Last day to drop a class without penalty
- ☐ Housing application for next year
- ☐ FAFSA renewal for next year
- ☐ Registration for next term's classes

WORTH KNOWING

- ◆ A student who never mentions a problem is not necessarily a student without one.
- ◆ Going to office hours is the single most under-used thing in college. Ask about it every time.
- ◆ The drop deadline is the one that quietly saves a GPA. Know the date.

